

UNIVERSAL JOURNAL

OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES

Journal Information, Publication Ethics
and Author Guidelines

UJHSS

Bi-monthly | Peer-reviewed | Open access

Published by

Universal Oneness Research Association (UORA)

Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar, Maharashtra, India

1. About the Journal

1.1 Journal Profile

The Universal Journal of Humanities and Social Sciences (UJHSS) is a bi-monthly, multidisciplinary, peer-reviewed, open-access journal devoted to the publication of high-quality research in the humanities and social sciences. The journal provides a scholarly forum for researchers, academicians, educators, policy professionals and practitioners to share original findings, critical perspectives and interdisciplinary approaches to questions affecting people, institutions, cultures and societies.

UJHSS welcomes research that is theoretically informed, methodologically sound and relevant to contemporary social, cultural, educational, political and economic life. The journal values intellectual diversity, ethical scholarship, transparent research practices and respectful engagement with different communities and traditions.

1.2 Mission

The mission of UJHSS is to advance knowledge by connecting rigorous humanities and social-science scholarship with public understanding, professional practice and constructive social development. The journal encourages work that explains human experience, interprets culture, evaluates institutions, examines public problems and contributes to informed decision-making.

1.3 Article Types

Article type	Description
Original research article	Empirical, conceptual or theoretical research that presents a clear question, appropriate method and defensible conclusions.
Review article	A critical and well-organised synthesis of published scholarship on a defined topic.
Theoretical or conceptual paper	A rigorous development, critique or application of concepts, frameworks or theories.
Case study	A contextual investigation of a social, cultural, educational, institutional or policy-related case.
Short communication	A concise report of a focused finding, method, dataset, argument or emerging research idea.
Book or policy review	A critical evaluation of a significant scholarly book, report, policy or public document.

1.4 Core Subject Coverage

Area	Representative subjects
Humanities	History, philosophy, languages, literature, cultural studies, religious studies, arts and heritage, media and communication, digital humanities.
Social sciences	Sociology, anthropology, psychology, economics, political science, public administration, geography, development studies, international relations and social work.
Education and values	Education, curriculum studies, teacher education, human values, ethics, citizenship, constitutional studies, human rights and peace studies.
Society and public life	Gender studies, migration, rural and urban studies, community development, public policy, governance, labour studies, disability studies and ageing.

Information and interdisciplinary studies	Library and information science, knowledge management, research methods, statistics for social research and interdisciplinary studies.
---	--

1.5 Publication Schedule and Access

UJHSS is intended to publish six regular issues each year. Special issues may be announced for conferences, thematic collections or emerging areas of scholarship. Articles are made freely available online after publication in accordance with the journal's open-access policy.

2. Aims and Scope

2.1 Aims

To publish original, ethical and methodologically credible scholarship in the humanities and social sciences.

To encourage dialogue among researchers working across disciplinary and methodological boundaries.

To connect academic research with social, cultural, educational, institutional and policy challenges.

To provide an accessible platform for scholars from India and other parts of the world.

To support the responsible communication of research to academic, professional and public audiences.

2.2 Objectives

Provide a dynamic multidisciplinary platform for sharing research, theory, methods and critical debate.

Promote scholarship that addresses local, national and global issues without compromising academic independence.

Encourage evidence-based discussion of society, culture, institutions, governance and human development.

Support national and international collaboration, including comparative and cross-cultural research.

Maintain fair, transparent and timely editorial and peer-review procedures.

2.3 Scope and Editorial Fit

Manuscripts should make a clear contribution to the knowledge, interpretation or practice of the humanities or social sciences. A submission may be quantitative, qualitative, mixed-methods, historical, philosophical, textual, legal, comparative or conceptual, provided that the approach is appropriate to the research question and explained sufficiently for evaluation.

The editorial team may decline manuscripts that are outside the journal's scope, lack a clear scholarly contribution, do not meet ethical requirements or are not presented in a form suitable for peer review.

3. Peer-Review Process

UJHSS follows a double-blind peer-review process. Author identities are removed from the manuscript supplied to reviewers, and reviewer identities are not disclosed to authors. Editorial decisions are based on scholarly quality, relevance, originality, ethical compliance and the quality of the response to reviewer comments.

Stage	Editorial action
Initial screening	The editorial team checks scope, completeness, formatting, authorship information, ethical declarations and similarity concerns.
Reviewer selection	A suitable manuscript is sent to at least two independent subject experts. Reviewers are selected for relevant expertise and absence of conflicts of interest.
Peer review	Reviewers assess the manuscript's contribution, method, evidence, interpretation, presentation and ethical suitability, normally within two to three weeks where practicable.
Decision	The Editor-in-Chief or designated editor decides to accept, request revision or reject, taking reviewer reports and editorial judgment into account.
Revision	Authors submit a revised manuscript and a point-by-point response. A revised paper may be returned to the original or additional reviewers.
Production	After acceptance, the article is copyedited and typeset. The corresponding author checks the proof before online publication.

The journal may reject a manuscript at any stage if serious ethical concerns, substantial duplication, fabricated material or a conflict with the journal's policies is identified.

4. Publication Ethics and Research Integrity

UJHSS is committed to responsible scholarly publishing. Authors, reviewers, editors and the publisher are expected to act honestly, fairly and respectfully. The journal addresses suspected misconduct through confidential assessment, requests for explanation, correction, rejection, retraction or other proportionate action where appropriate.

4.1 COPE-Inspired Practice

The journal is not represented as a registered member of the Committee on Publication Ethics (COPE). It follows COPE-inspired best practices as a framework for handling authorship, conflicts of interest, peer review, corrections, complaints, appeals, duplicate publication, plagiarism and retraction matters.

Guidance: <https://publicationethics.org/guidance/Guidelines>

4.2 Responsibilities

Participant	Expected responsibilities
Authors	Submit original work, report methods and sources accurately, obtain required approvals, disclose conflicts and respond honestly to editorial queries.
Reviewers	Provide objective, confidential and constructive assessments; identify relevant sources; and decline reviews where expertise or independence is insufficient.
Editors	Evaluate submissions fairly, protect confidentiality, manage conflicts and make decisions based on scholarly merit and policy compliance.
Publisher	Support the integrity of the editorial process, maintain publication records and assist with corrections or investigations when required.

4.3 Corrections and Retractions

Errors that affect the understanding of a published article may be corrected through a formal notice. Where research misconduct, serious error or unethical publication is established, the journal may retract or withdraw an article and retain an explanatory record in the publication history.

5. Plagiarism and Similarity Policy

All submissions may be screened for plagiarism, inappropriate text reuse, duplicate publication and other forms of academic misconduct. Authors are responsible for ensuring that the manuscript is original, that sources are cited accurately and that quotations and adapted material are clearly identified.

Situation	Editorial response
Similarity requiring revision	Authors may be asked to rewrite, quote, cite or remove overlapping material before peer review or publication.
Substantial unattributed copying	The manuscript may be rejected, and the authors may be asked for an explanation or further action may be taken under the ethics policy.
Misconduct discovered after publication	The journal may publish a correction, expression of concern or retraction, depending on the evidence and seriousness of the matter.

A similarity percentage is not by itself a complete plagiarism determination. The editorial team considers the location, nature, source and context of matched text. Authors should not attempt to manipulate similarity reports by replacing words without correcting attribution.

6. Policy on AI-Assisted Content

Artificial-intelligence tools may assist with language improvement, translation, formatting, transcription, coding or other limited tasks when their use is responsible and does not replace the authors' scholarly judgment. AI tools cannot be listed as authors because they cannot take responsibility for the accuracy, originality, ethics or integrity of a manuscript.

Authors remain fully responsible for every statement, citation, table, quotation, translation, image, dataset and conclusion in the submitted work.

Substantive use of generative AI should be disclosed in the manuscript or cover letter, including the tool and the nature of its contribution.

Authors must verify all AI-assisted text and references; fabricated citations, invented evidence and undisclosed content generation are unacceptable.

Confidential manuscripts, personal data and copyrighted material should not be uploaded to external AI systems without appropriate permission and safeguards.

Reviewers and editors must not use AI tools in a way that compromises manuscript confidentiality or transfers unpublished content to an unauthorised service.

7. Open-Access and Copyright Policy

UJHSS is intended to operate as an open-access journal. Published articles are made freely available online immediately after publication, subject to the journal's publication and licensing terms.

The journal uses the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International Licence (CC BY 4.0) for published content unless a different licence is stated for a particular article. This licence permits copying, distribution, adaptation and reuse, including commercial reuse, provided that the original authors and source are properly credited.

Authors retain attribution rights and grant the journal the right to publish, archive and disseminate the accepted work. Authors may deposit submitted, accepted and published versions in institutional or subject repositories, subject to accurate citation and the applicable licence.

8. Privacy and Copyright Statement

Names, institutional affiliations, email addresses and other information supplied during submission are used for editorial, peer-review, publication and communication purposes. The journal does not intentionally share personal information with unrelated third parties except where required for legitimate publishing operations, legal obligations or scholarly preservation.

Authors confirm that the manuscript is not under consideration by another journal, does not knowingly infringe third-party rights and contains appropriate permissions for copyrighted material, identifiable participants, photographs and data. The journal may correct, withdraw or retract content where rights or ethical requirements have been violated.

9. Author Guidelines

9.1 Before Submission

Confirm that the manuscript fits the aims and scope of UJHSS.

Ensure that the work is original and is not simultaneously submitted to another publication.

Obtain consent from all authors and identify one corresponding author.

Secure ethics approval or informed consent where the study requires it, and include the relevant statement.

Prepare a similarity report where requested and disclose any related publication, preprint, thesis or conference version.

Remove author-identifying information from the anonymised manuscript used for double-blind review.

9.2 Recommended Manuscript Structure

Section	Guidance
Title page	Title, author names, affiliations, ORCID where available, corresponding-author details and acknowledgements. Submit separately if required for blind review.
Abstract	A concise summary of the purpose, approach, key findings or argument and conclusion. Avoid citations unless essential.
Keywords	Provide approximately four to eight precise keywords that describe the topic and method.
Main text	Organise sections according to the article type. State the research problem, evidence or method, analysis and implications clearly.
Declarations	Include funding, conflict of interest, ethics approval, consent, data availability and AI-use statements as applicable.
References	List only sources cited in the manuscript and use one consistent referencing style.

9.3 Formatting and Presentation

Use clear headings and subheadings and maintain consistent terminology throughout the manuscript.

Use readable tables and figures with sequential numbering, descriptive titles and source or permission information where applicable.

Define abbreviations at first use and provide translations or explanations for specialised local terms where needed.

Use inclusive, respectful and non-discriminatory language. Avoid identifying research participants unless consent and necessity are established.

Check grammar, references, hyperlinks, units, statistical notation and page order before submission.

9.4 References and Research Transparency

Authors should cite primary and relevant sources, avoid unnecessary self-citation and provide complete bibliographic information. Data, instruments, interview protocols, coding frameworks or other materials should be made available where ethically and legally possible. Restrictions on data sharing should be explained.

9.5 Submission and Cover Letter

The cover letter should provide the manuscript title, article type, author details, a brief statement of originality, confirmation that the manuscript is not under consideration elsewhere, disclosure of conflicts and any relevant ethical or AI-use information. The editorial office may request additional forms or declarations during screening.

10. Article Processing Charges

UJHSS is an open-access journal. If an Article Processing Charge (APC) applies, it is payable only after the manuscript has completed peer review and has been accepted for publication. Payment is not a condition for editorial acceptance, and the editorial decision is independent of payment.

Author category	APC
Authors based in India	₹1,500
Authors based outside India	\$25 USD

The APC supports editorial administration, peer review coordination, copyediting, technical production, online hosting and routine publication services. The journal may offer waivers or discounts in cases of demonstrated need. Authors should contact the editorial office before payment to request consideration.

Payment methods may include NEFT, RTGS, PayPal or online transfer. Authors should use only payment instructions issued through the official journal contact channels.

11. Abstracting, Indexing and Archiving

The journal will provide current abstracting, indexing and archiving information through its official website and article pages. Inclusion in any database is subject to that database's independent evaluation and decision. Publication in UJHSS should not be interpreted as a guarantee of inclusion in a particular indexing service.

Authors should verify claims about indexing, journal evaluation or academic recognition through the relevant official database or organisation. The journal does not claim UGC-CARE inclusion unless the journal is shown on the current official UGC-CARE or successor listing.

12. Contact Us

Office	Contact details
Publisher	Universal Oneness Research Association (UORA) E-1/8 Mathura Nagar, N-6, Cidco, Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar, Maharashtra 431003, India
General enquiries	Email: contact@uorapublications.com Phone: +91 97669 30707
Editor-in-Chief	Prof. Pawan D. Somavanshi (Ph.D. Mechanical) Email: editor@uorapublications.com Phone: +91 90964 99989
Managing Editor	Dr. Swapnil N. Dhole (Ph.D. Mechanical) Email: editor@uorapublications.com Phone: +91 89832 45607